

---

## **THE INTERCONNECTEDNESS BETWEEN INTERCOLLEGIATE POLICY DEBATE AND THE URBAN DEBATE LEAGUES: FROM A DISTANCE, FIVE YEARS AND CHANGE LATER**

*C. Thomas Preston, Jr.*

---

*Note: Separate from the CAD Forum organized for this issue by Professor Loudon, the following essay by Professor Preston continues a lengthy conversation in the discipline about privilege and debate.--BRM*

For the past twenty years, a movement to expand the policy debating activity to include many new high schools in urban areas has taken root. According to the National Association of Urban Debate Leagues web site (<http://www.naudl.org/factsheet>, 2005), "Urban Debate Leagues currently exist in fourteen of the nation's largest cities, encompassing 221 urban public high schools and 40 middle schools. Since 1997, more than 12,000 urban public school students have competed and more than 700 urban educators have received professional development" (¶2). What started out as a series of tournaments in Atlanta around 1985 has turned into a national consortium of cities offering competitive interscholastic policy debating in high schools where before 1985, debate had long been eliminated as an activity due to budget cuts. Although many of the new leagues, spurred by the IMPACT Coalition of New York and the Atlanta models, were started with seed money from the Open Society Institute of New York grant money, many of these leagues and programs continue to flourish well after their initial grants.

---

From August 1998 to May of 2001, I had the privilege of co-administering a partnership with the Urban Debate League of St. Louis. Five years and change removed from this involvement, as well as my involvement as a fulltime forensics director, I base my observations not only on 18 years as a director, co-director, or interim director of forensics, but from a vantage point to offer insights from a distance, with all of the big-picture advantages and the drawbacks of disengagement that come from that distance. Not only do I hope that this article will be looked at as a “thank you” for many, many past favors and the involvement of the benefactors, teachers, and students in urban debate leagues everywhere, but also as an invitation for others to share their most recent stories regarding debate outreach and issues. These stories, in turn, will provide a reality check not only for directors of forensics, debate coaches, facilitators, practitioners, financial supporters and administrators, but also for the larger number among us in whose classes argumentation permeates all aspects. Such a reality check cannot help to benefit our students—including my current students here and now at Gainesville State College here in north Georgia—plus those whom I may adjudicate in local tournaments at various levels. Hopefully, such discussion can benefit the others’ students as well.

This essay, therefore, contains three parts: 1) one view of the *healthy start* for the nationwide Urban Debate League phenomenon and its interconnectedness with intercollegiate policy debating; 2) one view of *change* surrounding the pedagogical efficacy of interscholastic and intercollegiate policy debate to reach those debate claims to reach; and 3) one view of the experience from my own *social location*. The summative questions posed at the end of this reflection are designed to invite a continuation of this discussion.

### **Healthy Start for the Urban Debate League Movement**

#### *Student Stories.*

It did not take the movement long to attract the attention of local and national media (Shields & Preston, 2007). In these

stories, soon after the leagues gained momentum in the late 1990s, much anecdotal evidence reflected in this 2007 study began to arise as many students began to comment on how much the movement to extend the debating activity to urban areas had provided a profound impact on their lives. For example, with respect to critical thinking, Catrell Hayes, participating in the St. Louis urban debate league, commented in 2000 that “We use critical thinking, and that’s a good exercise for the mind” (Mueller, 2000). Stephen Hayes, participating in the urban debate league sponsored by the Chicago Debate Commission, added that same year that “It challenges your mind. It forces you to think critically. I think that debate is something everybody needs in society” (Keoun, 2000). Ed Lee, commenting on his urban debate league experiences from years earlier, concludes that “The Urban Debate League provides a space for us to learn what justice is because it forces us to learn from those disproportionately affected by injustice” (Lee, 1998, p. 93). With respect to reading skills, Marcus Carnes of the St. Louis urban debate league said that, “I’m learning more about the policymaking system, and I know this is helping my vocabulary” (Mueller, 2000). Anthony Mason, commenting on his experience with the urban debate league, said that “I’m always learning new words and new things” (Ghezzi, 2000). Carnes’s and Mason’s comments reflect the notion (Tucker, 2003) that “the greatest and most fundamental challenge faced by our country remains ensuring that America’s children have the literacy skills necessary to succeed in college classrooms, at workplaces, and around the democratic public sphere” (p. 5). And with respect to grades, another competitor stated, “My grades have gotten better, and my study skills have gotten better. (Mueller, 2000). In 2002, Angelo Brooks, a coach of an urban debate league program, noted that his team’s grades increased by 10 or 15 points (Morris, 2002).

#### *Qualitative Research.*

The notions of critical thinking skills, improved vocabulary and reading skills including research, and improved academic

performance continued to characterize the narratives which began to emerge in qualitative research studies concerning the urban debate leagues. Implying *how* policy debate promotes critical thinking by empowering the individual, Gregory and Alimahomed (2001) state that “Within resolutions there is enough freedom to accommodate a marginal voice—and in finding similarities between the urban debater and the oppressed narrative of a resolutorial actor, the debater finds him/herself transformed” (p. 10). In terms of academic performance, Warner and Bruscke (2001) note, “Debate participation also has the potential to improve traditional grades and test scores. In a very direct way, many underachieving students, once ‘gone on debating,’ become better academic performers.” A chorus of voices in the 1998 issue *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate* (Wade, 1998; Breger, 1998; Baker, 1998; Lynn, 1998; Warner, 1998; Crenshaw, 1998; and Ziegelmüller, 1998) celebrated the early successes of the urban debate leagues, with each article coming around to conclusions either related issues regarding increased critical thinking abilities, increased academic skills, and improvement in academic performance.

### *Empirical Data*

As the urban debate league movement progressed, empirical studies regarding the leagues emerged. Some of the data were not so encouraging; other data were. Arbenz and Beltran (2001), although noting that debate benefited Latinas, concluded that “Results of this study reveal that the amount of wins a debater earned was directly correlated to his or her gender/ethnicity. Latinas had the lowest overall winning percentage, followed by non-Latina females, followed by Latinos and then finally, non-Latino males” (p. 11). But although their study concluded that within their sample in that given year, Latinas won fewer debates, they later went on to laud debate’s potential to “open the door for more widespread participation” and “improve academic skills” (p. 12). According to the NAUDL web site and other studies (Preston & Shields, 2003; Preston, 2004; Shields & Preston, 2007), urban

debate participation improves grades, increases a willingness to argue and increases debate knowledge among its participants, even within a first year. Clearly, the positive *educational* benefits for those who debate—even for one year—are well-established. On the other hand, especially considering that Friere's (1970, 1985, 1994, 1997, and 1998) and hooks' (1994) notions of empowerment and engagement informed the formation goals of urban debate leagues, a question does arise as to whether current debating pedagogy furthers empowerment and engagement, as well as the UDL's focal student's ability to discover *political* empowerment in later life.

### About that Change (in Debate)

Because what happens in intercollegiate policy debate both affects and is affected by debate in the urban debate leagues, intercollegiate debate pedagogy trends have a great deal of impact on participation in urban high school debate. The discussion of educational practices in high school and college debating are therefore inextricably intertwined, especially since a great deal of resources goes into training the urban debaters and coaches in collegiate high school debate institutes and workshops. As the NAUDL website <http://www.naudl.org/factsheet> (2005) states, "there are more than 70 university debate programs that make special outreach efforts for urban debaters, some of them including dedicated scholarships. UDL students have been granted more than \$1 million in university summer institute scholarships over five years. Strong university partnerships provide mentoring, training, and professional development" (¶4). So, what goes on in national circuit debating has a profound influence on what occurs in the urban debate leagues. In turn, what constitutes an exemplar for excellent debating informs how a much broader number of educators teach the argumentative elements of their classes.

Therefore, a key question arises: is the *traditional education* success that students who stay in the UDL's learn what the UDL's teach, with apologies to Martha Stewart, a "good thing" with regards to [critical enlightenment snipped] *political engagement*

when the two principles diverge? The extant literature indicates that I am not the only person with this question. Even before the UDL movement had "gone national," Hill (1997) had noted that learning and communication styles of African Americans may differ from the learning and communication norms of the policy debating community. After the UDL movement had become established nationally, McRee and Cote (2002) still noted that a lack of diversity in intercollegiate debate was still "inherited" from a similar lack of diversity in high schools. Most notably, beginning in the fall of 2000, the University of Louisville debating society began to challenge the types of policy debating, derived from the traditional NDT circuit, then being taught in the Urban Debate Leagues. Along with other universities experimenting with variations, Louisville has achieved a great deal of success and influence with the new approach. As reflected in the title "Malcolm X Debate Society," Louisville's emphasis is on debate as a form of political empowerment. This approach varies from the teaching experienced by the focal groups of prior impact-of-debate studies.

At the same time, one of the urban debate league events trainings I attended in Fall of 2005 indicated that judges were to apply strictly a stock issues model to the participants. When I asked the question as to whether Louisville's Malcolm X style of performance-oriented debating was permitted, I was told emphatically no, and to use a logos-centric, stock issues paradigm within my judging. So, on the one hand, I continue to celebrate that number of new opportunities the urban debate leagues continue to open up. The mainstream *educational* benefits seem to be well established, at least among those who continue to stay in debate. However, are mainstream debate practices empowering student who may aspire to *political* activism? And, would many more urban debaters stay with the activity if encouraged, as is the case with some of the high schools, to employ performance-oriented as well as traditional evidentiary strategies? From a distance, and spurred by ideas expressed informally at NCA programs sponsored by CEDA at which advocates of various

performance-oriented programs have appeared, I sometimes wonder if a part or the whole of the urban debate movement has been co-opted, or is somehow reinventing a dysfunctional wheel by utilizing the traditional-rational evidentiary approach as an entry point for new debaters—and, whether this is the best approach for teaching the principles of effective political engagement in communication classes where teaching argumentation skills effectively is critical.

At this point in my life, I am unsure whether competitive debate is prepared to assist students interested in political activism to transfer the educational benefits of debate into such activism. I can, however, be convinced to become more certain. To address where I stand *now* and to spur the dialogue, I now offer my own narrative that offers some background on my social location<sup>4</sup>. So doing uncovers key questions that should be explored to inform how I, and others who care about the education of the marginalized as well as the privileged, should proceed as educators. Although empirical research will play its role in establishing the educational benefits of debate, only narrative dialogue can contribute a layered richness of analysis that assists us to teach debate as a vehicle for constructive social change--or lack of change, when in instances community turns in a constructive direction. Indeed, as Hill (1997) suggests, the best pedagogy and dialogue occur when unconstrained by the box of Eurocentrism (or any -centrism) couched as seemingly neutral "objective practical reality."

### **My Location of Privilege**

#### *Early Years*

Throughout my life, I have benefited from privilege on a high number of levels. Born in 1957, I grew up in a loving, Caucasian middle class family on the western outskirts of Winston-Salem, NC. Although this community, as other Southern communities, was segregated, race and class played very little role in my childhood social consciousness. The Winston-Salem riots of 1967 began to shatter that lack of consciousness—although I cannot blame the racism I fight internally to my forebears as each person

is responsible, I can still remember the national guards being called in to quell the violence that affected the areas around Trade and Liberty streets that today form an increasingly gentrifying arts district in my childhood home town. However, negative racial images abounded in the media. “Panthers in our midst” was a headline I remember from the local newspaper in those days.

Incredible as it may seem, the Winston-Salem/Forsyth County schools were determined to be segregated as late as 1970, and integration only commenced with a court order with the 1971-72 school year. Although some of our neighbors moved to what was then nearly all-white Davie County to avoid the busing, my parents encouraged me to try to make integration work. It was at the 9<sup>th</sup> and 10<sup>th</sup> grade school to which I was bused in, Paisley High School, where I was first introduced to debating. And, surprise, surprise, debating helped my critical thinking and research skills. I continued debating in the 11<sup>th</sup> and 12<sup>th</sup> grade at the R. J. Reynolds High School, aptly named for the late baron of the community’s (in)famous tobacco industry. During this time, however, even though my high school individual events coach was African American, only token representation existed in debate of many marginalized or non-white population-aside for a few individuals. This was the case at Paisley, which was transformed overnight from an historical African American institution to over 75 per cent Caucasian. “RJR” had a similar blend, although it had been an all white institution as late as the early 1960s.

### *College Years*

I decided to take a year off of forensics to get established at my chosen college alma mater, the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill. Having tried extemporaneous speaking and oratory in high school, I decided it more reasonable to join the individual speaking events team my sophomore year in college. The year was 1976-1977, a time not long after UNC itself was integrated, and during which approximately only 600 or so African American students attended the University. During those years, I had a striking experience that affects my view of forensics and debate to

this day—the privilege of belonging to one of the nation’s most highly integrated individual events programs. Two patterns emerged during my three year involvement with the squad—first, at many events (particularly in the Northeast), UNC would actually have the majority of African Americans attending in the entire tournament, unless Morehouse College and Spelman College, which dominated the southeastern individual events circuit in the late 1970s, attended. From my recollection, many of my teammates, along with the Morehouse and Spelman competitors—were to individual events then as Louisville is to debate today—those who pave the way for the future empowerment of others. Some adjudicators raised eyebrows when there was no compromise in speaking and performing on African American issues. I remember a white backlash to split up the Morehouse and Spelman speech team at the N.F.A national individual events tournament in 1977 as if it were yesterday every time I read of Louisville in debate today. But the success was also undeniable—competitors doing what they do well, and making the critics like it.

Second, by contrast, at the debate tournaments I sometimes visited, I do not recollect seeing *any* African Americans participating in those days. Yet by participating on the UNC speech events team, I was able to learn much about African American perspectives that I would not otherwise have learned. And, I gained a passion for diversity in forensics—admittedly, mainly because it worked! By my senior year UNC was in the top ten in individual events, where it remained for two more years. But, I also was profoundly perplexed as to why debate remained relatively segregated—I certainly did not see the highly successful debaters or debate coaches I knew at UNC as being any more or less racist than I was or my individual events teammates were, or any less friendly to people of color. Yet there, and elsewhere, debate seemed to be more of a “white” activity. Evidently, around this time or shortly thereafter, those at Emory began to ask the same question—what can be done to make debate as an activity less exclusive, therefore able to make debate more relevant?

---

*Coaching Years*

Through no special talents or efforts of my own, I had the privilege of helping to coach a very diverse and dedicated squad throughout my 17 years at the University of Missouri-St. Louis, both in debating and in individual speaking events. It is this diversity, plus ten years of participation in a highly successful summer mock trial institute partnership with the St. Louis Internship Program of the St. Louis Public Schools, that helped justify the St. Louis partnership with Washington University and Webster University during my three year involvement with the Urban Debate League in St. Louis. As noted earlier, studies have shown the benefits of those participating in both this and other urban debate leagues to the students who decided to join. Once again though, as Don Shields and I were working on our Fantasy Theme Analysis of the UDL movement, the book editor's questions revolved around our proofs regarding the UDL impact on long-term *political* empowerment or activism as an impact to the UDL educational program. By the end of our revision process, we ended up having to conclude that on the political empowerment issue, the jury is still out.

*The Gypsy Years*

Up until 2001, although I had had the privilege of meeting persons from all over the world within the academy, the primary racial issues I had encountered in life revolved around the historical roots of class differences and economic opportunities between the Caucasian and African American communities. My experiences changed with a series of opportunities to teach in places where although racial tensions were not "black and white" as in the case of the United States in earlier years, they were nevertheless similar. And, I began to learn that the notion of privilege was not limited to myself, to those of the United States Southeast, to debate per se, or even to the United States—but rather, that debates over privilege arise throughout the world, sometimes within a political party. For example, my experiences teaching argumentation at the International College of Beijing in

the early summers 2001 and 2002 revealed that the notion of offering curricula in Tibetan and of affirmative action-type issues for various ethnic minorities in China was as controversial on many levels as race, class, and cultural identity within the United States. My interim teaching position at Rocky Mountain College in Billings, Montana, during 2001-2002 proved educational of the myriad class issues revolving around the local Crow reservation, both between the Caucasian and Crow communities, and within the Crow community. Similar discussions of privilege ensued during my 2003-2004 year visiting the University of Texas at Brownsville, although this time the discussions involved Latino and Latina issues, as well as many sub-groupings thereof. I would have to write a whole series of articles to explain the myriad issues of race, nationality, ethnicity, sexual orientation and class related by students I had the privilege of teaching in the summer of 2005 at Miami Dade College in Kendall, Florida.

This all brings me back to north Georgia, an area that looks topographically very much like the area of the world in which I grew up. At the same time, though, race and class here in Gainesville is not a solely a Caucasian and African American affair anymore. Within the past decade, the Gainesville high schools have become majority Latino and Latina. As well there is a thriving Asian community in Hall County, as well as a much larger Asian community in neighboring Gwinnett County. Similar trends throughout the United States will inevitably add new challenges to debate as a vehicle not only for practical educational skills for the workplace, but as a vehicle for political engagement. Therein also lies vast potential for excellence.

#### Future Questions, and Change

Right now, I believe from the extant evidence that the Urban Debate League phenomenon has already gone far in providing many traditional educational benefits and opportunities to its participants. Some of the UDL programs have adopted the performance-oriented style of debating as an approach. Nevertheless, I do invite the readers to further engage the following questions through both updated research and editorial

pieces. In fact, fertile ground exists for research programs resulting in publication arising from addressing the following questions:

1. Is learning “rapid fire delivery” – something touted in one of the publicity articles on the UDL website – really serving the underserved – or is it causing its more of the UDL target students to quit debate than to stay?
2. If the debating activity is to be reformed in directions away from elitism, then why are there still round robin and mutually preferred judging tournaments? Also, do these structures perpetuate elitist debating styles and practices counterproductive to growth in diverse participation and benefit?
3. Why compete at all? Can we have exercises in mediation via teleconferences that are free to everybody?
4. The college debating season goes from September to March or April, and virtually every regular season tournament lasts for three days. Is this necessary? And, does it discourage the working student from participating, hence constituting one of the oppressive structures—to borrow from Pink Floyd, another brick in the wall?
5. Does the type of evidence usage rewarded in CEDA/NDT and most UDL rounds promote an intellectual elitism by relying on a limited number of experts at the expense of marginalizing certain voices?
6. Inasmuch as they focus on traditional evidentiary debating as a starting point, could the UDL’s be creating pawns for an existing elitist policy debate structure? Or, considering that some of the UDL programs have adopted more activist and performative approaches, are UDL’s now providing opportunities for students to create discourse that can be truly liberating, in addition to providing the educational benefits traditionally attributed to debating?

And, most notably and pointedly,

7. How does competitive debate respond in its outreach efforts to an increasingly complex blend of national, race, and class issues in not only urban, but rural, areas as well?

---

In fairness, and to invite discussion, research articles, and editorial replies from the performance-oriented debate advocates, I will also pose research questions similar to what I often hear proposed by other communication and argumentation educators:

1. Is the resolution necessary or does it prevent the liberation of the mind?

2. Haven't the students of differing cultural groups who have been succeeding across the individual speaking events for years been practicing for decades what was much more recently discovered in CEDA/NDT debating? And, if a metaphorical approach to debating is employed more universally to the point that evidentiary debating is marginalized or eliminated altogether, what would a student learn different from individual events, by participating in college policy debate?

3. How would a grown up "Beaver or Opie" with traditional debate training judge a round between two teams employing the same metaphorical approach in a debate, or are guidelines themselves oppressive (which brings me back to, "why compete?")?

And, if the reform in debate is to discuss social location and race, should Beaver and Opie be invited in the first place? If so, what roles do they play when they grow up to be coaches, or become involved in endeavors such as the urban debate movement, or reform of policy debating? Most importantly, how can they best serve whatever student appears in their path?

4. Can metaphors be used in debate to reflect ideologies other than Afrocentrism (such as, a feminist attacking the competitive aspect of debate [Beattie, 1998] for being too male and confrontational in style)? What happens if a student offering a politically conservative position plays a country music song as a metaphor for an issue, such as "Have you Forgotten" to argue for US preemptive military action against "terrorists"? With regards to the interrelation between the debate ballot itself as a tool for political activism, the question surrounding competition arises again.

5. The Pi Kappa Delta debating community has been calling for reforms regarding speed for years. Should this community – once a core group within the NDT as late as the seventies, and later

in CEDA-- be invited back in, or at least some dialogue established between schools which have switched to non-evidentiary parliamentary debating and/or individual speaking events only?

6. Are the proponents of performance-oriented debate arguably internalizing the age-old stereotype that traditionally marginalized groups "cannot keep up with the flow?"

7. In this information age where we have to process large amounts of information, would a shift to debate with less emphasis on traditional evidence stifle research skills and perpetuate the future marginalization of our debate students both in graduate work and in information-oriented professions where traditional evidence usage isn't going away any time soon? A good reply to this question might be that the Louisville approach to evidence actually requires a *higher* standard of research, since it challenges us to consider *more* types of material and sources as evidence than we did in the past.

There are many other questions that arise other than this "couplet of sevens". Only future research will both raise and help address them. Such discussion will hopefully help the students of us who teach argumentation across our curriculum. Indeed, the potential applications of such research potentially hold not only have impacts on our approaches to UDL and CEDA debate pedagogy, but also to argumentation pedagogy across both communication and other disciplines in the broadest, global sense.

## References

- Arbenz, C., & Beltran, S. (2001, February). *Empowering Latinas through debate: An analysis of rates of success at SCUDL tournaments of Latina debaters*. Paper presented at the meeting of the Western States Communication Association, Coeur d'Alene, ID.
- Baker, W. (1998). Reflections on the New York Urban Debate League and 'Ideafest II'. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 69-71.
- Breger, B. (1998). Building open societies through debate. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 66-68.
- Crenshaw, C. (1998). Sharing the gift of debate: Notes from the Tuscaloosa Debate League. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 80-84.

- 
- Freire, P. (1970). *Pedagogy of the oppressed* (M. B. Ramos, Trans). New York: Herder and Herder.
- Freire, P. (1985). *The politics of education: Culture, power, and liberation* (D. Macedo, Trans.). South Hadley, MA: Bergin and Garvey.
- Freire, P. (1994). *Pedagogy of hope: Reliving Pedagogy of the oppressed* (R. R. Barr, Trans.). New York: Continuum.
- Freire, P. (1997). *Pedagogy of the heart* (D. Macedo & A. Oliveira, Trans.). New York: Continuum.
- Freire, P. (1998). *Pedagogy of freedom: Ethics, democracy, and civic courage* (P. Clarke, Trans.). Lanham, MD: Rowman and Littlefield.
- Ghezzi, P. (2002, June 24). Good learning talked up at Emory: Urban students make statement with debate. *Atlanta Journal-Constitution*, p. B-1.
- Gregory, J., & Alimahomed, K. (2001, February). *Narrative voice and the urban debater: An investigation into empowerment*. Paper presented at the meeting of the Western States Communication Association, Coeur D'Alene, ID.
- Hill, S. K. (1997). African American students' motivation to participate in intercollegiate debate. *The Southern Journal of Forensics*, 2, 202-235.
- hooks, b. (1994) *Teaching to transgress: Education as the practice of freedom*. London: Routledge.
- Keoun, B. (2000, January 21). War of words inspires students to succeed. *Chicago Tribune*, p. 3. Retrieved October 26, 2003, at <<http://www.urbandebate.org>>.
- Lee, E. (1998). Memory of a former urban debate league participant. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 93-96.
- Lynn, L. (1998). Debating funding, funding debating: The Chicago Debate Commission's tale of two cities. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 72-75.
- McRee, N. & Cote, R. (2002). Does college debate inherit a lack of diversity from high school debate? *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 23, 28-44.
- Mission Statement (2000). University of Louisville Debate Society Web Site. Retrieved December 17, 2005, from <http://comm.louisville.edu/~debate/mission.html>.
- Morris, H. (2002, July 17). League of their own: Inner-city debate teams are on the rise, and they're bringing student achievement with them. *U.S. News and World Report*. Retrieved October 26, 2003, at <<http://www.urbandebate.org>>.
- Mueller, M. (2000, February 21). Debate league students are gaining essential skills. *St. Louis Post Dispatch* (West Post), p. 9.

- 
- National Association of Urban Debate Leagues' Home Page (2005). Retrieved February 14, 2005, at <<http://www.urbandebate.org/newsStory?id=52>>.
- Preston, Jr., C. T. (2004, November 13). *Fundamental debate competence and recruitment and retention in Urban Debate Leagues*. National Communication Association Convention, Chicago, IL.
- Preston, Jr., C. T. & Shields, D. C. (2003, October 18). *The impact of urban debate league training and experience on willingness to argue among high school students*. International Debate Education Association Conference, Dubrovnik, Croatia.
- Shields, D. C. & Preston, Jr., C. T. (2007, in press). The urban debate league rhetorical vision: Empowering marginalized voices for leadership and activism." Forthcoming in a book concerning communication and political activism, ed. Larry Frey.
- Tucker, E. (2003). Building high schools to educate the new majority: Teachers see UDLs as an instrument to improve critical literary skills. *The Urban Debate Chronicle* 2:1, 5.
- Wade, M. M. (1998). The case for urban debate leagues. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 60-65.
- Warner, E. (2001). NDTceda Archives. URL: <http://www.ndtceda.com/archives/200102/0866.html>.
- Warner, E., & Bruschke, J. (2001, February). Gone on debating: Competitive academic debate as a tool of empowerment for urban America. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 22, 1-21.
- Ziegelmüller, G. W. (1998). The Detroit Experience. *Contemporary Argumentation and Debate*, 19, 85-88.

C. Thomas Preston, Jr. (Ph.D. Nebraska) is Professor of Communication, Gainesville State College (GA).

Copyright of Contemporary Argumentation & Debate is the property of Cross Examination Debate Association and its content may not be copied or emailed to multiple sites or posted to a listserv without the copyright holder's express written permission. However, users may print, download, or email articles for individual use.